

Kansha

User's Guide

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Chapter 1

Introduction

Know where your money went. Trust every number.

Kansha keeps your household accounts: checking, savings, credit cards, loans, and investments. You enter what you spend and earn, Kansha remembers the bills that come every month, and you reconcile each account against its statement. For investments it keeps every lot with its cost basis, so capital gains come out right at tax time. Reports and the Insights cards show where the money went, what you're worth, and what goes on your tax return.

Kansha was built to replace Quicken 2013. It reads the QIF files Quicken exports, so years of history come with you (see Coming from Quicken).

Kansha is Japanese for *gratitude*; the brushstrokes on the cover are the word in Japanese script.

> **Quick Start**
> The first time Kansha starts, it asks for three things: a name for your book, a folder for its backups, and a passphrase. Then add an account and start entering transactions. Getting Started has the details.
> If you'd rather look around first, choose **Load sample data** in a new, empty book. It fills the book with three years of made-up accounts and transactions to try things on.

Getting Help as You Go

Hold the pointer over a button or a choice and a tooltip says what it does. Many choices in dialogs also say when to pick them.

This guide is for when you want more than a tooltip: what a screen is for, how to read it, and what to do next. Your First Month follows a month of household money from start to finish. Recipes walks through common jobs, and Something Doesn't Look Right explains the most common surprises. The Glossary defines the terms.

Help > User's Guide opens this guide from inside Kansha.

What Do You Want to Do?

Start from your question and go to the screen that answers it.

I want to...	Go to
Bring my Quicken history into Kansha	Coming from Quicken
Add a bank, card, loan, or investment account	Accounts
Set up the categories my spending goes into	Categories, Payees, and Tags
Enter what I spent or earned	The Register
Have Kansha remember bills and paychecks	Scheduled Transactions
See what's coming up and what my balance will be	Scheduled Transactions, the Calendar
Check an account against its statement	Reconciling
Record buying, selling, and dividends	Investments
See where my money went	Reports, Insights
Get the numbers for my tax return	Reports, Tax reports
Enter a purchase from the terminal or my phone	Entering from the Command Line
Keep my data safe, or move it to another computer	Backups and Restore
Change dates, colors, or what opens at startup	Settings and Themes

Your Data Stays With You

Everything you enter is stored on your own computer, in one file called a *book*. No account is needed, and nothing is sent anywhere. Kansha never connects to the internet unless you turn on **Allow price download** in Settings, and then it sends only the ticker symbols of the securities whose prices it fetches.

The book is encrypted. Without your passphrase, the file can't be read, by anyone.

> **Why this matters**
> Encryption protects you if the computer or a backup drive is lost or stolen. It also means that **nobody can recover your book if you forget the passphrase**: not Kansha, not its author, not a computer shop. Keep the passphrase in a password manager, or written down somewhere safe, from the day you set it.

Kansha backs up the book by itself: when you close it, a few minutes after you change something, and before any big change such as an import. A backup on the same disk doesn't survive a failed disk, so choose a backup folder somewhere else: a USB drive, a network drive, or a cloud-synced folder (see Backups and Restore).

Moving Around

> **Screenshot**
> The main window with a checking account's register open: the menu bar, the navigation bar with its buttons and the Search box, the Accounts panel on the left, and the status bar.

Across the top is the **menu bar**: File, Edit, Tools, Reports, and Help. At its right end are the book's name and the theme, font, and text size lists.

Under it is the **navigation bar**. Its buttons go straight to the screens you use most; to start with, Insights, Reminders, Calendar, Reconcile, and Investments. You choose its buttons and their order in **Edit > Navigation Bar...**: any menu item or any account can have a button. The Reminders button shows how many reminders are due.

At the left end of the navigation bar are **Back** and **Forward**. They step through the screens you've visited since the book was opened, like a web browser's. Hold the pointer over one to see where it goes. At the right end is the **Search** box: type a payee, a category, a memo, a check number, or an amount to find every transaction that matches.

The **Accounts** bar sits under the navigation bar. Click the triangle at its left to open the Accounts panel, the list of all your accounts with their balances, grouped by type; click an account to open its register. With the panel closed, click the rest of the bar to drop the list down instead. The gear at its right arranges the list. **Edit > Settings...** puts the panel on the left or the right.

On the same row, on the other side, is the **status bar**. Kansha reports there when it has made a backup or saved an export. A note clears itself after 30 seconds. An alert, such as a backup that failed, is in bold, flashes, and stays for a minute.

Windows and the dock

Reports, the Calendar, Reminders, Reconcile, and Investments each open in a window that fills the space under the bars. Several can be open at once. The ones underneath wait in the **dock**, a row of labels at the bottom of the main window; click a label to bring that window back to the top. Opening an account's register leaves the windows in the dock.

Keyboard shortcuts

Keys	What they do
Ctrl+N	A new transaction in the register
Ctrl+Z	Undo the last change in a register (outside a text field)
Ctrl+F	Put the cursor in the Search box

On a Mac, use Cmd for Ctrl. The register itself works entirely from the keyboard (see The Register).

Chapter 2

Getting Started

> **At a glance**
> Install Kansha, then answer the three questions on its setup screen: a name for the book, where its backups go, and the passphrase that locks both. After that, Kansha asks for the passphrase each time it starts.

Install Kansha

Kansha runs on Kubuntu and other Ubuntu-based Linux systems, and on Windows. Both installers are on the **Releases** page of Kansha's GitHub repository. Download the newest one for your system.

Kubuntu and Ubuntu

Download the file ending in `_amd64.deb`, open a terminal in the folder you saved it to, and install it:

```
sudo apt install ./Kansha_0.13.0_amd64.deb
```

Use the name of the file you downloaded. Kansha then appears in the application menu. To install a newer version, do the same with the newer file; your books and settings stay as they are.

Windows

Download the file ending in `_x64-setup.exe` and run it.

The installer isn't signed, so Windows may show a blue box saying **Windows protected your PC**. Click **More info**, then **Run anyway**. The installer puts Kansha in the Start menu.

> **Why this matters**
> Signing an installer means buying a certificate every year, which a free, single-user app doesn't need. The warning only says that Windows doesn't know who made the file. Download Kansha only from its own Releases page, and the file is the one that was built there.

Set Up Your First Book

A **book** is where Kansha keeps everything: your accounts, transactions, categories, schedules, and settings. It is two files side by side in one folder: `<name>.db`, the data, and `<name>.key`, the key that unlocks it. Most people need one book.

The first time Kansha starts, it shows the **Set up** screen. It has three steps, top to bottom.

> **Screenshot**
> The Set up screen on first start: 1. Book with Create a new book chosen, the Name and Folder, Start with; 2. Backup folder;
> 3. Backup passphrase with its warning.

1. Book

Leave **Create a new book** chosen. (If you already have a Kansha backup, choose **Restore from a backup** instead; see Backups and Restore. To use a book you already have, for example on a USB drive, click **Open an existing book...**.)

Name is the book's name. It becomes the name of the book's files and of its backups, so it can use only letters, digits, -, and _, up to 40 of them: `household`, `kansha`, `smith-family`.

Folder is where the book's files go. Kansha suggests its own data folder; click **Browse...** to choose another.

Start with decides what the new book holds:

- **Empty** has only the few categories Kansha itself needs. Choose it if you're going to import your Quicken data, which brings its own categories.
- **Standard categories** adds a ready-made list of household categories, such as Food:Groceries and Tax:Fed, with the tax-related ones already marked and matched to their lines on the tax forms. Choose it if you're starting fresh.

2. Backup folder

Kansha makes backups by itself, and they all go to this folder. It starts as your Downloads folder.

Click **Browse...** and choose a folder that isn't on this computer's disk: a USB drive, a network drive, or a folder that a cloud service such as Dropbox or OneDrive keeps in sync.

> **Why this matters**
> A backup in Downloads is on the same disk as the book. If the disk fails or the computer is lost, both go together. A backup somewhere else is the only copy that survives.

3. Backup passphrase

Type a passphrase twice. It unlocks the book, and every backup of it.

> **Write it down now**
> **If the passphrase is lost, the book and every backup are lost with it.** Kansha can't recover it and can't open the book without it. Before you click Create book, save it in a password manager or write it down and keep it somewhere safe.

A passphrase is easier to remember and harder to guess than a password: four or five ordinary words with spaces between them, such as `copper kettle on the porch`, is a good one. You'll type it each time Kansha starts.

Click **Create book**. The window grows to its working size and the new book opens.

Your First Look

A new book has no accounts, so Kansha shows **No accounts yet** with two buttons:

- **New account...** starts your own book. Accounts explains the account types and what to enter. Start with your main checking account, with its balance from your last statement.
- **Load sample data** fills the book with about three years of made-up accounts, transactions, schedules, and investments, ending a few weeks from today. Use it to try Kansha out.

> **Kansha Tip**
> Try the sample data in a book of its own: make a book called `sample` (**File > New...**), load the sample data there, and click around as much as you like. When you're done, **File > Recent** switches back to your real book.

If you're coming from Quicken, don't add accounts by hand: import them, with their history (see Coming from Quicken).

Opening Kansha Each Day

From then on, Kansha starts with a small window showing the book's name and asks for the **Backup passphrase**. Type it and click **Open**. A wrong passphrase is simply asked for again.

> **Screenshot**
> The small passphrase window with the Kansha mark, the book's name and path, the Backup passphrase box, and the links underneath.

Kansha opens the book you used last. Under the passphrase box are links for the other choices:

- **Open:** followed by the names of the other books used on this computer. Click one to open it instead.
- **Open another book...** picks a book's `.db` file from a folder.
- **Create a new book...** makes a new book beside the others.
- **Restore from a backup...** brings back a book from one of its backups.

When the book opens, Kansha shows the screen chosen in Settings, Insights to start with (see Settings and Themes).

When you're done, close the window or choose **File > Exit**. Kansha backs up the book as it closes.

Pick a Theme and Text Size

Three lists at the right end of the menu bar change how Kansha looks:

- **Theme**: Nordic (the default), Light, Dark, Classic (which looks like Quicken 2013), and Matrix (green on black).
- **Font**: System (your computer's own), Arial, Verdana, or Courier New.
- **Font size**: from 10 to 24 pixels; 13 is the default. Everything grows with it, the columns too.

Changes take effect at once. These three are kept for this computer, not in the book, so the passphrase window uses them too.

Where Kansha Keeps Things

What	Kubuntu	Windows
Books, unless you chose another folder	`~/.local/share/tools.astryx.kansha/`	`%APPDATA%\tools.astryx.kansha\`
This computer's settings: theme, font, window size, recent books	`~/.config/tools.astryx.kansha/config.json`	`%APPDATA%\tools.astryx.kansha\config.json`
Backups	The backup folder you chose	The backup folder you chose

A book can live anywhere, a USB drive included. To move one, close Kansha and move both its files, `.db` and `.key`, together; then start Kansha and open it with **Open another book...**.

> **Note**
> Every other setting, such as the date format or which screen opens at startup, is kept inside the book. It moves with the book and comes back when a backup is restored.

Chapter 3

Coming from Quicken

> **At a glance**
> Export your whole Quicken file as one QIF file, then import it with **File > Import...**. Kansha shows what it found before it changes anything, lets you test the import first, and can take a whole import back out again. Schedules are entered again by hand.

Kansha reads the QIF files Quicken 2013 exports. One file brings your accounts, categories, tags, payees, securities, prices, and every transaction, with both sides of each transfer matched up. Investment history comes too, and Kansha rebuilds every lot from it.

Before You Start

Make a fresh book for the import, with **Start with** set to **Empty** (see Getting Started). The import brings its own categories, so a standard list would only get in the way.

> **Kansha Tip**
> Import into a throwaway book first, called something like `trial`. Check it over. If you don't like what you see, delete the book's two files and start again. When the result is right, make your real book and import into that.

Export from Quicken

In Quicken 2013:

1. Choose **File > Export > QIF File**.
2. Under **Quicken account to export from**, choose **All Accounts**.
3. Leave the dates at their widest, so everything comes.
4. Tick every box under **Include in export**: transactions, the account list, the category list, memorized payees, and the security lists.
5. Save the file somewhere you can find it, such as `quicken-all.qif`.

> **Why this matters**
> A QIF of one account holds only that account's transactions: no account names, categories, tags, or securities, and only one side of each transfer. The whole-file export holds all of it, so Kansha can match every transfer to its other side and import it once.

Kansha can read a single-account QIF too, for a quick trial; its transactions go to an account named after the file.

Import the File

Choose **File > Import...** and click **Choose QIF file...**. Kansha reads the file and shows the **Import from Quicken** window. Nothing has been changed yet; the file waits in memory until you click **Import**.

> **Screenshot**
> The Import from Quicken window after reading a file: the summary of records, dates, and counts at the top, the Accounts table with its Import as choices, and the Categories, tags, securities section.

The summary

The top of the window says what the file holds: how many transactions, how many transfers were matched, the new payees, the prices, the dates the transactions run from and to, and the memorized transactions that are skipped.

Date order. QIF files don't say whether `3/4/26` is March 4 or April 3. Kansha looks for a date with a day over 12 to decide. When no date decides it, it assumes month first and says so with a ⚠; if that's wrong, choose **Day first (31/1/26)** under **Date order**.

Accounts

One row for each account in the file, with its records, its dates, and what it adds to the balance. For an investment account that's the cash only.

For each account, choose what **Import as** does:

- **New account**: Kansha creates it, with the name and type shown. You can change both.
- **Existing account**: the transactions go into an account already in the book.
- **Skip**: the account is left out. Use this for Quicken's hidden accounts that you don't want to bring along. A transfer to a skipped account goes to Opening Balance instead.

Kansha matches each QIF account to the book's account of the same name when there is one.

Categories, tags, and securities

Each category, tag, and security the transactions use is listed, with what it maps to: a new one, or one already in the book. You can map a category to an existing one to merge two on the way in, or give it a new path to rename it.

Only what the imported transactions use is created. To keep the others too, such as categories you used before the dates in the file, tick **Show the … the imported transactions do not use** and tick the ones to keep.

A security that no account holds after the import, an old holding, is created hidden, so price downloads pass it by. Tick it to keep it shown.

Import … prices of the securities kept brings Quicken's price history along. Leave it ticked unless you don't want old prices.

Problems and notes

Cannot be imported lists records Kansha can't read, each with its line number in the file. They stop the import, unless you tick **Import the rest and leave these out**.

Notes lists what Kansha noticed but can import anyway: sections it doesn't import (budgets and the like), transfers to accounts left out, and transfers with only one side in the file.

Some choices stop the import until they're fixed: two QIF accounts onto one Kansha account, a banking account onto an investment one, a name or ticker already taken, a category under one of the other kind. Kansha says which.

Test, Then Import

Click **Test import**. Kansha runs the whole import, shows the result, and then puts everything back as it was. Nothing is kept.

The result lists each account's balance before and after, against what the file says it adds, and marks any difference.

When the test looks right, click **Import**. Kansha backs up the book first, then imports everything in one step: either all of it goes in, or none of it does.

> **Note**
> Kansha keeps a copy of every file it imports, encrypted like a backup, in a folder beside the book called `<book>-imports`. If you import a file that was imported before, the preview says so.

Check the Result

Compare Kansha with Quicken before you rely on it:

1. **Balances.** Each account's balance in the Accounts panel should match Quicken's account list on the day you exported.
2. **Categories by year.** Run **Reports > Spending > Income/Expense by Category** with **Interval** set to **Year**, and compare a few years against the same report in Quicken.
3. **Investments.** Run **Reports > Investing > Holdings** and compare shares and cost basis with Quicken's portfolio view.

Lines that had no category in Quicken are in **Uncategorized**. The Needs attention card on Insights lists them by account, so you can fix them when you have time.

Lots and Your Broker

QIF files carry no lots. Kansha rebuilds them from the buys, sells, and reinvestments, using each account's lot method. For most holdings the result matches your broker's. Where it doesn't, the broker's records are the ones the IRS sees.

To make a holding match, download its cost-basis list from the broker as CSV, then use **True up lots…** in **Tools > Securities** (see Investments).

Undo an Import

File > Import… > Past imports… lists every import with its file and the number of transactions. **Roll back…** deletes that import's transactions, with the accounts, categories, payees, tags, and securities it created that nothing else uses. The book is backed up first.

What Doesn't Come Across

- **Scheduled transactions.** Enter your bills and paychecks again in Reminders (see Scheduled Transactions). It's a good time to tidy them.
- **Hidden accounts**, unless you import them. QIF doesn't mark which accounts are hidden, so skip them yourself in the Accounts table.
- **Budgets**, reports, and Quicken's settings.
- **Older Quicken files.** If you started a new Quicken file at some point, only the current one is imported.

Quicken Words in Kansha

Quicken	Kansha
Data file	Book
Class	Tag
QuickFill, memorized payee	Memorized payee
Scheduled bill or deposit	Schedule (Reminders)
Bills and Income Reminders	Due and overdue
Home page	Insights
Investing Center	Investments
Account Bar	Accounts panel
Toolbar	Navigation bar
Tax line item	Tax line

Chapter 4

Your First Month

> **At a glance**
> This chapter follows one month of household money through Kansha: setting up accounts, entering spending, letting reminders handle the bills, reconciling the statements, and seeing where it all went. Each step points to the chapter with the details.

The example is a household with a checking account, a credit card, and a paycheck twice a month. Yours will differ in the details, but the rhythm is the same.

Day 1: Set Up

1. **Make the book.** Start Kansha, name the book, choose a backup folder off this computer, and set a passphrase you've written down. Choose **Standard categories**, unless you're importing from Quicken (see Getting Started or Coming from Quicken).
2. **Add the checking account.** Click **New account…**, name it, leave **Type** at **Checking**, and save. Its register opens.
3. **Enter its starting balance.** Take the balance from your last statement. In the register's empty line, enter the statement's date, the payee `Opening Balance`, the balance under **Deposit**, and the category **Opening Balance**.
4. **Add the credit card** the same way, with **Type** set to **Credit card**. Its starting balance is what you owe, under **Charge**.

See Accounts for the other kinds of account.

Week 1: Enter What You Spend

Each time you spend or receive money, enter it in the register of the account it came from (see The Register):

- Click the empty line at the bottom, or press **Ctrl+N**.
- Type the date, the payee, the amount, and the category, then press **Enter**.

The second time you type a payee, Kansha fills in the category, memo, and amount from the last time. Most entries then take a few keystrokes.

> **Kansha Tip**
> A grocery run that was partly household goods is a split: one transaction, two categories. Click the **Split** button at the end of the entry line and give each part its own line. See The Register.

Away from the computer? Enter it from a terminal or your phone, and approve it the next time Kansha is open (see Entering from the Command Line).

Week 1: Set Up Reminders

Bills and paychecks that come again and again don't need typing each time. Open **Reminders**, click **New schedule**, and fill in:

- the paycheck: a deposit to checking, **Twice a month** on the days you're paid;
- the rent or mortgage: a payment, **Monthly on a day**;
- the electric bill: a payment whose amount changes. Set **Amount** to **Average of past payments**, and Kansha estimates it from the last few bills.

From then on, when a bill is due Kansha shows it under **Due and overdue**. Click **Enter**, check the amount against the real bill, and save. See Scheduled Transactions.

The **Calendar** shows the month with every bill and paycheck on its day. Tick **Projected balance** with checking chosen to see whether the account stays above zero all month.

End of the Month: Reconcile

When the bank statement comes, open **Reconcile**, choose checking, and enter the statement's date and ending balance. Tick each transaction that's on the statement. When **Difference** reaches 0.00, click **Finish**. Do the same for the credit card statement.

A difference that won't go away is almost always a transaction missing on one side, entered twice, or typed with the digits swapped. See Reconciling.

End of the Month: Look Back

- **Insights** shows the month on one page: net worth, this month's income and spending, what's due soon, and anything that needs attention (see Insights).
- **Reports > Spending > Income/Expense by Category** with the date range at **Last month** lists where the money went. Click any amount to see the transactions behind it.
- **Reports > Comparison > Current Spending vs. Average by Category** shows which categories ran over their usual.

See Reports.

Every Month After

The rhythm settles into a few minutes a week:

1. Enter what you spend, or approve what you entered on your phone.

2. Enter the reminders as they come due.
3. Reconcile each statement when it arrives.
4. Glance at Insights. Anything under **Needs attention** says what's wrong and links to where to fix it.

Kansha backs up the book by itself all along. Once in a while, check that the backups are where you expect them (see Backups and Restore).

Chapter 5

Accounts

> **At a glance**
> An account is anywhere money is kept or owed: a checking account, a credit card, a brokerage account, a house. Add one with **New account** in **Tools > Accounts**. Its starting balance is the first transaction in its register. The type is chosen once and can't be changed later.

Account Types

Type	Use it for	Kind
Checking	A bank account you write checks or pay bills from	Asset
Savings	A savings account	Asset
Money market	A bank money market account	Asset
Cash	Cash in your wallet or a jar	Asset
Credit card	A credit card or store card	Liability
Brokerage	A taxable investment account	Asset
Traditional IRA	An IRA or rollover IRA	Asset
Roth IRA	A Roth IRA	Asset
HSA	A health savings account	Asset
401(k)/403(b)	An employer retirement plan	Asset
Donor Advised Fund (DAF)	A charitable fund you advise	Asset
Other asset	A house, a car, money someone owes you	Asset
Other liability	Money you owe that isn't a loan or card	Liability
Loan	A mortgage, car loan, or student loan	Liability

An **asset** adds to your net worth; a **liability** takes away from it. The six investment types (Brokerage through DAF) have an investment register that tracks securities, shares, and lots as well as cash (see Investments). The rest have the ordinary register (see The Register).

> **Why this matters**
> The type decides which register an account has, how its columns are named, and how it's treated in reports and for taxes. Changing it later would change the meaning of every transaction already in it, so Kansha fixes it when the account is made. If you chose wrong, make a new account of the right type and move the transactions.

Add an Account

Choose **Tools > Accounts** and click **New account**. (In a new book, the **New account…** button on the empty screen does the same.)

> **Screenshot**
> The New account dialog for a checking account: Name, Type, Group, Tax treatment, Opening date, Institution, Account number with its Reveal button, Interest rate, and the Show in account list box.

Only **Name** and **Type** are needed. The rest can be filled in now or later:

Field	What it's for
Name	What the account is called everywhere in Kansha
Type	See the table above. Fixed once saved
Group	Which section of the Accounts panel it's listed in
Tax treatment	Taxable, Tax-deferred, or Tax-exempt; see below
Tax line, transfers out / in	The tax form line money moving out of or into it belongs on
Opening date	The day the account was opened
Institution, Phone, Web address	Where the account is held
Account number	Shown as dots; **Reveal** shows it
Description, Notes	Anything you want to remember
Interest rate (%)	Checking, savings, and money market accounts
Credit limit	Credit cards; the register shows the credit left
Sort order	The account's place within its group
Show in account list	Untick to keep an account out of the Accounts panel

Click **Save**. The new account appears in the Accounts panel.

The starting balance

There is no opening balance field. The starting balance is an ordinary transaction, the first one in the register:

- **Date:** the date of the statement you take the balance from.
- **Payee:** `Opening Balance`.

- **Amount:** the balance, under **Deposit** for a bank account, or under **Charge** for what you owe on a card.
- **Category: Opening Balance**.

> **Why this matters**
> As a transaction, the starting balance has a date, shows in the register, and can be reconciled against the first statement like anything else. Opening Balance is a built-in category that reports leave out of income and spending, so the starting money doesn't look like a paycheck.

An investment account starts with its holdings instead; see Investments.

Tax treatment

Tax treatment says how the IRS sees money in the account:

- **Taxable**: a bank or brokerage account. Its interest, dividends, and capital gains go on your tax return.
- **Tax-deferred**: a traditional IRA or 401(k). Nothing is taxed until it's taken out. New IRA and 401(k) accounts start here.
- **Tax-exempt**: a Roth IRA, an HSA, or a DAF. New Roth, HSA, and DAF accounts start here.

The tax reports and capital gains reports use it to leave out what isn't taxed (see Reports).

Investment settings

Investment accounts have a few more fields:

- **Cash**: **Internal** keeps the account's cash inside it. **Linked** keeps it in a separate checking or savings account chosen under **Linked cash account**, as some brokers do.
- **Money market funds**: whether a money market fund in the account counts as cash or as a security.
- **Default lot method**: which shares a sale takes when you don't choose them yourself (see Investments).

Other assets

An **Other asset** has a **Kind**: house, vehicle, or other. A house or car bought with a loan can name that loan as its **Linked liability**.

The Accounts Panel

The Accounts panel down the side of the window lists the open accounts with their balances, in sections: Banking, Credit, Investments, Retirement, Assets & debt, and Other. Net worth is at the bottom. Click an account to open its register.

- **Show closed accounts** at the bottom brings back closed ones.
- The gear opens **Arrange accounts**. ▲ and ▼ move an account up or down its section; the list beside it moves the account to another section.
- Settings can show the balances with or without cents (see Settings and Themes), and put the panel on the left or the right.

Change, Close, or Delete

To change an account's details, open **Tools > Accounts** and click **Edit…** beside it. From a register, the gear (**Account options**) has **Edit account details…**.

At the bottom of the account dialog:

- **Close account** puts away an account you no longer use. Its transactions stay, and reports still count them. Its balance should be zero first, with no shares left; if not, Kansha asks before closing it. **Reopen** brings it back.
- **Delete** removes the account entirely. It works only on an account with no transactions.
- **History…** lists every change made to the account's details: the field, the value before, and the value after.

> **Kansha Tip**
> Close an account rather than deleting it. A closed account keeps its history for reports and taxes, and stays out of the way.

Chapter 6

Categories, Payees, and Tags

> **At a glance**
> A **category** says what money was for: groceries, salary, rent. A **payee** says who it went to or came from. A **tag** marks transactions across categories, such as everything for one trip. Each has its own list under **Tools**, where you can rename, hide, merge, and delete.

Categories

Every transaction line has a category, or a transfer account instead (see The Register). The reports add up the categories to show where money came from and went.

Each category is **Income** or **Expense**. Categories nest: a category can sit under another, and its full name is the path, with `:` between the levels, such as `Auto:Fuel` or `Tax:Fed`. A report can show the parent with its subcategories folded in or spread out.

The category list

Choose **Tools > Categories**.

> **Screenshot**
> Tools > Categories with the list of categories on the left and the selected category's Name, Kind, Parent, Tax-related, Tax line, and Hidden fields on the right, with Merge into below.

Click a category to see and change it:

Field	What it's for
Name	The category's own name, without its parent. It can't contain `:`
Kind	Income or Expense
Parent	The category it sits under, or **(top level)**
Tax-related	Ticked when the category matters for taxes
Tax line	The line of the tax form it belongs on
Hidden	Keeps it out of the lists you pick from

New adds a category. To make a subcategory, set its **Parent**. To move a category, with everything under it, to another place, change its Parent.

You can also make a category as you type it in the register: type a name that isn't in the list, and Kansha asks whether to create it.

Tax lines

A tax-related category with a tax line set shows up on the **Tax Schedule** report under that line, such as Schedule A, medical and dental, so the report reads like the form (see Reports). The Standard categories come with the usual ones set already.

Built-in categories

A few categories belong to Kansha itself:

Category	What it holds
Opening Balance	Each account's starting balance
Uncategorized	Lines entered with no category
Balance Adjustment	What reconciling adds to make an account match its statement
Tax Withheld	Tax held back from an investment payment
Dividends, interest, capital gains	Investment income, filled in by the investment register

Only a built-in category's tax settings and **Hidden** can change.

Merge, hide, or delete

- **Merge into** moves every transaction from this category to the one you choose, then removes this one. Use it to clean up two categories that mean the same thing.
- **Hidden** keeps a category you no longer use out of the lists, while its old transactions stay where they are. Reports still show it.
- **Delete** works only for a category no transaction uses. For anything else, hide it or merge it.

> **Kansha Tip**
> Merging can't be taken back with Undo, but Kansha backs up the book first. Look at the category in a report before you merge, so you know what's moving.

Payees

A payee is created the first time you type a new name in the register. Kansha remembers it, with the category, memo, and amount from its last use. The next time you type that payee, it fills them in for you. This is called a **memorized payee**.

Choose **Tools > Memorized Payees** to see the list. Each row shows the payee and what its last use would fill in: **Category**, **Memo**, and **Amount**. **Show all payees** includes the hidden ones.

Click a payee to:

- change its **Name**, which renames it on every transaction;
- tick **Hidden**, so it's no longer offered as you type;
- **Merge** it into another payee, so a misspelling such as `Kroger's` joins `Kroger`;
- **Delete** it, if no transaction uses it.

Settings decides how payees are remembered: whether to recall them at all, whether new ones are memorized, whether names are capitalized as you type, and whether payees unused for some months are dropped (see Settings and Themes).

Tags

A tag marks transactions that belong together but have different categories: everything for a vacation, a rental property, or a wedding. Quicken calls them classes.

Choose **Tools > Tags** to list them. **New** adds one; click one to change its **Name**, hide it, **Merge** it into another, or **Delete** it.

In the register, type the tag in the **Tag** column. In a split, each line can have its own tag. Every spending and tax report can be filtered to one tag or a few (see Reports).

> **Kansha Tip**
> Use a tag instead of a new category when the question is "how much did this one thing cost?" Groceries on vacation are still groceries; tag them `Maine 2026` and the trip's total is one report away.

Chapter 7

The Register

> **At a glance**
> Each account has a register: its transactions, one per row, oldest at the top, with the running balance down the right. Enter a new one on the line at the bottom. Click a row, or press Enter on it, to change it. Most of the work in Kansha happens here.

This chapter covers the register of a bank, cash, card, loan, or other account. Investment accounts have their own register; see Investments.

Open a Register

Click the account in the Accounts panel. The register opens with the newest transactions in view and the entry line ready at the bottom.

> **Screenshot**
> A checking account register: the filter bar on top, rows with Date, Num, Payee, Payment, Deposit, Category, Tag, Memo, Clr, and Balance, a split row, future rows in italics below the line at today, the entry line at the bottom, and the footer with Cleared, Current, and Ending balances.

The Columns

Column	What it holds
Date	When the transaction happened
Num	A check number, or anything you like such as `ATM` or `EFT`
Payee	Who the money went to or came from
Payment, Deposit	The amount, in the column for its direction
Category	The category, a transfer account, or `--Split--`
Tag	An optional tag (see Categories, Payees, and Tags)
Memo	A note
Clr	`c` once cleared, `R` once reconciled
Balance	The account's balance after this transaction

The two amount columns are named for the kind of account:

Account	Money out	Money in
Checking, savings, money market	Payment	Deposit
Credit card	Charge	Payment
Cash	Spend	Receive
Loan, other liability	Increase	Decrease
Other asset	Decrease	Increase

Click a column heading to sort by it; click it again to reverse the order. The heading shows ▲ or ▼. The line at today shows only when the register is sorted by date.

Transactions dated after today are in italics, below a line that marks today. They're in the **Ending** balance, but not yet in **Current**.

The footer

- **Cleared**: the balance of the cleared and reconciled transactions. It should match the bank's balance, give or take what hasn't reached the bank yet.
- **Current**: the balance as of today.
- **Ending**: the balance after the last transaction, future ones included.
- **Available credit**, for a credit card with a credit limit.

Enter a Transaction

Click the entry line at the bottom, or press **Ctrl+N** or **Insert**. Fill in the fields left to right, pressing **Tab** to move on, then press **Enter** or click **Enter**.

Date. Type it in the book's date format. A short date is completed: `3/5` is March 5 of this year. In the date field, **+** and **-** move the date a day forward or back, and **t** sets it to today.

Num. Optional.

Payee. As you type, Kansha offers the payees that start with what you've typed. When you pick one it already knows, it fills in the category, memo, and amount from the last time; change any of them as needed.

Amount. Type it in one of the two columns. The amount can be a sum: `12.50+3.25` or `3*4.99`. Type `=` or move on, and Kansha works it out.

Category. Kansha offers matches as you type, one level at a time: type `au`, take `Auto`, then `:`, and only Auto's subcategories are offered. To move money to another account, pick the account instead; accounts are listed after the categories (see Transfers below).

Tag and **Memo.** Optional.

> **Kansha Tip**
> Press **Escape**, or click **Cancel**, to throw away what you've typed on the entry line.

Warnings

Kansha may ask before saving a transaction that looks like a mistake:

- its date is more than 7 days ago or more than 30 days ahead;
- its check number is already used in this account;
- a line has no category.

Each warning can be turned off in **Settings > Notifications** (see Settings and Themes).

Splits

A split is one transaction with more than one category: a store receipt that was part groceries and part household goods, or a paycheck with salary, taxes, and a 401(k) contribution.

Click the **Split** button at the end of the entry line, or choose `--Split--` as the category. The split panel opens.

> **Screenshot**
> The split panel under a paycheck: lines for Salary, Tax:Fed, Tax:State, and a transfer to the 401(k), each with Amount, Tag, and Memo, the Add line button, and Remainder showing a check mark.

Give each part a category or transfer account and an amount. A part going the other way, such as the taxes taken out of a paycheck, is typed with a leading `-`. **Add line** adds another line.

Remainder shows what's left to assign. When the lines add up to the transaction's amount it shows ✓; until then, ✗ and the amount left. A transaction is saved only when the remainder is zero.

> **Kansha Tip**
> For a paycheck, enter the net pay that reached the bank as the amount, then split it: gross salary as a positive line, and each deduction as a negative line. The tax reports then see every part.

Transfers

Money moved between two of your accounts, such as a credit card payment from checking, is a **transfer**. Enter it once, in either account, and put the other account in the **Category** column. Kansha writes it in both registers.

In the other register, it shows with the account you entered it from as its category. To jump there, right-click the row and choose **Go to other side of transfer**.

> **Why this matters**
> A transfer isn't income or spending. It only moves money between your own accounts, so it changes no category and leaves net worth as it was. Entering it as a transfer, not as an expense in one account and income in the other, keeps the reports honest.

Change a Transaction

Double-click a row, or select it and press **Enter**. It opens for editing where it is; change it as you would a new one, then click **Save** or press **Enter**. Enter then moves on to the next row, so you can work down the register.

Right-click a row, or press **Shift+F10** or the Menu key, for more:

Command	What it does
Edit	Opens it for changing
Split	Opens it with the split panel
Mark cleared / Mark unmarked	Sets or clears the c in Clr
Go to other side of transfer	Opens the other account's register at this transaction
Schedule this...	Makes a schedule from it (see Scheduled Transactions)
History...	Every change made to it: the field, before, and after
Void	Keeps the transaction but makes its amount zero
Delete	Removes it

Undo (**Ctrl+Z**, or **Edit > Undo**) takes back the last change in a register: an entry, a change, or a delete.

The keyboard

With a row selected:

Key	What it does
↑ ↓	Previous or next row
Home, End	First or last row
Page Up, Page Down	A page up or down
Enter	Change the row
Space	Mark it cleared, or unmark it
Delete	Delete it
Insert, Ctrl+N	Go to the entry line
Shift+F10, Menu key	The right-click menu

Filter the Register

The bar above the rows narrows what's shown: **From** and **To** dates, **Payee**, **Category**, **Tag**, and **Cleared** (All, Unmarked, Cleared, or Reconciled). **Clear all** shows everything again.

Find and Replace

Ctrl+F, or **Edit > Find**, puts the cursor in the search box on the navigation bar. It finds transactions in every account by payee, category, memo, note, check number, account name, or amount.

Edit > Find/Replace... finds transactions that match one or more conditions and changes them all at once:

1. Choose a field (Amount, Category, Check #, Cleared status, Date, Memo, Payee, or Tag), a comparison (Contains, Exactly, Starts with, Ends with, Greater, Less, and so on), and the value.
2. **Add row** for more conditions, joined by **And** or **Or**. **Show matches within splits** lists matching split lines.
3. Tick the matches to change, or use **Select all**.
4. Choose the **Replace** field, type what goes in **With:**, and click **Replace all**.

> **Kansha Tip**
> Kansha backs up the book before **Replace all**, and one Undo reverses the whole replacement.

Cleared and Reconciled

When a transaction shows on your bank statement or online banking, mark it cleared: press **Space** on it, or right-click and choose **Mark cleared**. Clr shows c.

Reconciling with a statement changes cleared transactions to R (see Reconciling). Reconciled transactions show in gray, which Settings can turn off. Changing one asks first, since it would undo work you've checked against a statement.

A closed account's transactions can't be changed until the account is reopened (see Accounts).

Chapter 8

Scheduled Transactions

> **At a glance**
> A **schedule** is a transaction that comes again and again: a paycheck, the rent, the electric bill. Kansha reminds you when one is due, or enters it by itself. **Reminders** lists every schedule; the **Calendar** shows them on the days they fall, with the balance they leave.

Reminders

Click **Reminders** on the navigation bar, or choose **Tools > Reminders**.

> **Screenshot**
> The Reminders view: the New schedule and Due and overdue buttons, and the table of schedules with Date due, Payee, Amount, Account, How often, Remind, # left, End date, and Mode.

Each row is one schedule, in order of the date it's next due:

Column	What it shows
Date due	When it's next due
Payee, Amount, Account	What it enters, and where
Method	Payment or deposit, in the account's own words
How often	Monthly, every 2 weeks, and so on
Remind	How many days ahead it shows as due
# left, End date	When it stops, if it does
Mode	**Remind** or **Auto**; **estimate** when the amount is an average

Click a row to change the schedule itself.

Make a Schedule

Click **New schedule**. Or, in a register, right-click a transaction you want to repeat and choose **Schedule this...**; the dialog opens filled in from it.

Screenshot
The New scheduled transaction dialog for an electric bill: Account, Payee, Transaction type, Amount set to Average of past 3 payments, the category, and the Scheduling section set to Monthly on a day.

What it enters

- **Account**: the account it's entered in.
- **Payee** and **Memo**.
- **Transaction type**: payment or deposit (charge or payment for a card, and so on).
- **Amount and category**. The split button beside the category makes it a split, such as a paycheck with its deductions. A transfer account can stand in for the category, for a monthly move to savings or a card payment.

The amount

Amount has two choices:

- **Fixed**: the same amount each time.
- **Average of past payments**: the average of the last few payments entered from this schedule, 3 unless you change it (1 to 99). Kansha keeps it up to date as payments are entered, changed, or deleted. Use it for a bill that changes, such as electricity. You put in the real amount each time you enter one.

An average needs a single category, not a split, and the **Remind me** mode, since someone has to check the real bill.

When it's due

Frequency:

Frequency	Example
Only once	A tax payment due April 15
Daily	
Weekly	Every Friday, or every 2 weeks with **Every** set to 2
Twice a month	Paid on the 15th and the last day
Monthly on a day	Rent on the 1st
Monthly on the last day	
Monthly on the Nth weekday	The second Tuesday, or the last Friday
Quarterly	Estimated taxes
Twice a year	Car insurance
Yearly	A subscription

First due on or after is the first date it falls on. Kansha takes the first date on or after it that fits the frequency. When you change a schedule, the box reads **Next due on or after**.

End: **Never**, **On a date**, or **After a number of occurrences**. With a number, **# left** counts down as each one is entered.

How it reminds you

Remind days before due is how early it shows as due: 3 shows a bill three days before its date.

Mode:

- **Remind me**: it waits in **Due and overdue** for you to enter it.
- **Enter automatically (flag for review)**: Kansha enters it on its date by itself. **Due and overdue** then lists it under **Entered automatically: please review** until you click **Reviewed** (or **Mark all reviewed**). To change or void one, use the account's register.

Click **Save**.

> **Note**
> Changes to a schedule apply to this occurrence and all the ones after it. Transactions already entered from it stay as they are.

Due and Overdue

When something is due, Kansha opens **Due and overdue** as the book opens. You can open it any time with the **Due and overdue (n)** button in Reminders.

> **Screenshot**
> The Due and overdue dialog with three rows: an overdue rent payment, an electric bill marked Estimate, and a paycheck, each with Enter, Skip, and Edit… buttons.

For each one:

- **Enter** opens the account's register with the transaction filled in. Check it, change the amount if it's an estimate, and save.
- **Skip** passes over this occurrence; the next one moves up.
- **Edit…** opens the occurrence's **Date** and **Amount**. Change them and click **Set for this occurrence only** to change this one occurrence, such as a paycheck that comes a day early for a holiday, without changing the schedule. The row then shows **This one edited**; **Undo the change** puts it back. (A split's amount is changed in the register after entering.)

Only the earliest occurrence of each schedule can be entered or skipped; the later ones wait their turn.

If you delete a transaction that was entered from a schedule, the occurrence comes back as due.

The Calendar

Click **Calendar** on the navigation bar, or choose **Tools > Calendar**.

> **Screenshot**
> The Calendar for one month with checking chosen and Projected balance ticked: each day lists its scheduled transactions, with the balance at the end of the day under it.

The month shows each scheduled transaction on the day it falls. Use the arrows to move a month, and **Today** to come back.

- **Account**: **All accounts**, or one checking, savings, cash, or credit card account.
- **Projected balance**, with an account chosen, shows the balance at the end of each day, counting what's entered and what's scheduled. Look for a day where it falls below zero, so you can move money in time.
- **Show entered transactions** adds what's already in the register.

Click a day to see what falls on it, and to **Enter**, **Edit**, or **Skip** a scheduled one, or make a **New schedule** on that date.

> **Kansha Tip**
> Before a big purchase, open the Calendar on checking with Projected balance ticked. The lowest day of the coming weeks is how much you can spend without going short.

Chapter 9

Reconciling

> **At a glance**
> Reconciling checks an account against its statement. Enter the statement's date and ending balance, tick each transaction the statement shows, and when the difference is zero, click **Finish**. Then you know Kansha and the bank agree, up to that date.

Why Reconcile

A transaction typed with two digits swapped, entered twice, or never entered at all throws off every balance after it. Reconciling finds it while the statement is in front of you, a month at a time, instead of a year later.

Once an account is reconciled, its transactions up to the statement date are marked R and checked. The next reconciliation starts from there.

Start

Click **Reconcile** on the navigation bar, or choose **Tools > Reconcile**, and pick the account.

> **Screenshot**
> The Reconcile view's New statement section for checking: Statement date, Ending balance, the optional Interest earned and Service charge, and the Start reconciling button.

Under **New statement**:

1. **Statement date** and **Ending balance**, from the statement. For a credit card, enter the balance you owe as the statement shows it.
2. **Interest earned** (optional; **Finance charges** for a card): the amount, date, and category, if the statement shows some you haven't entered.
3. **Service charge** (optional): the same, for a bank fee.
4. Click **Start reconciling**.

Kansha enters the interest and the charge as transactions, so you don't have to.

Tick What the Statement Shows

> **Screenshot**
> Reconciling checking: the figures at the top with Difference, and two tables below, Payments and checks on the left and Deposits on the right, with some rows ticked.

Two tables list the account's transactions that aren't reconciled yet: money out on one side, money in on the other. Their names follow the account: **Payments and checks** and **Deposits** for a bank, **Charges and cash advances** and **Payments and credits** for a card.

Go down the statement. For each item on it, click its row in Kansha; the tick shows it's on the statement. The box at the top of a table ticks or clears all of it.

The figures at the top keep count:

Figure	What it is
Opening balance	The ending balance of the last reconciliation
Checked payments, Checked deposits	The ticked items on each side, with their count
Cleared balance	The opening balance plus everything ticked
Statement ending balance	What you typed from the statement
Difference	Statement ending balance minus cleared balance

When **Difference** is 0.00, click **Finish**. The ticked transactions become R, and the session is kept in the account's history.

Update changes the statement date or ending balance, if you typed one wrong.

You can leave in the middle. The session is kept, marked **(in progress)** in the account list, and picks up where you left off the next time.

When It Won't Balance

Work through these, in order:

1. **Missing transaction.** Something is on the statement but not in Kansha. Go back to the register, enter it, and come back; it's in the list, ready to tick.
2. **Extra transaction.** Something is ticked that isn't on the statement. Compare the counts: the statement says how many checks and deposits it holds.
3. **Wrong amount.** If the difference divides evenly by 9, two digits are probably swapped: 45.10 for 54.10.
4. **Entered twice.** Look for a difference that equals one transaction's amount.
5. **Wrong statement.** The opening balance should match the statement's starting balance. If not, see below.

When you can't find it and the difference is small, **Balance Adjustment…** enters a transaction for the difference, in the built-in **Balance Adjustment** category, so you can finish. It shows only while the difference isn't zero.

> **Why this matters**
> A balance adjustment makes the account agree with the bank without saying why it didn't. Use it for the cents you've given up on, not for a difference you could still find; the transaction it hides may matter for taxes.

Abandon throws the session away. Nothing is marked reconciled. Interest or a service charge it entered stays in the register; delete it there if you don't want it.

Opening Balance Changed

If a reconciled transaction is changed or deleted after the fact, the opening balance of the next reconciliation no longer matches the last statement. Kansha shows ⚠ **Opening balance changed.** and lists the reconciled transactions that changed since then, so you can put them right.

History

Under the account, the history table lists each reconciliation: its **Statement date** and whether it's **Finished**, **In progress**, or **Abandoned**. **Show items** lists the transactions it reconciled.

Chapter 10

Investments

At a glance
An investment account holds securities as well as cash. Each buy, sell, dividend, or reinvestment is entered in the account's register through a dialog that knows what the action needs. Kansha keeps the **lots** (which shares were bought when, and for how much) so it can work out capital gains. The **Investments** screen shows every holding at today's prices.

Investment Accounts

The investment types are Brokerage, Traditional IRA, Roth IRA, HSA, 401(k)/403(b), and Donor Advised Fund (see Accounts). Each has:

- its **holdings**: shares of securities, in lots;
- its **cash**, kept in the account itself or in a linked checking or savings account;
- a **tax treatment**, which decides whether its income and gains show on the tax reports;
- a **default lot method**, which decides which lots a sale takes.

Securities

A security is a stock, fund, bond, or anything else with shares and a price. Choose **Tools > Securities** to list them.

Screenshot
Tools > Securities with the list on the left and one fund's Name, Ticker, Type, Class, and the Prices table on the right, with Import prices..., Seed lots..., and True up lots... below.

Field	What it's for
Name	The security's name
Ticker	Its symbol, such as VTI; price downloads use it
Type	Stock, ETF, mutual fund, bond, money market, CD, or other
Class	Its asset class, for the Asset Allocation report
CUSIP	Optional
Notes	Anything you like

Field	What it's for
Hidden	Keeps an old security out of the lists and price downloads

New security adds one; a new security takes its type's usual asset class.

Delete works only for a security no transaction uses; hide it otherwise.

The Investment Register

Click the account in the Accounts panel.

> **Screenshot**
> A brokerage register: rows with Date, Action, Security, Shares, Price, Comm., Amount, Cash, Clr, and Memo, a reinvestment and a sale among them, and the line New transaction: type or click here at the bottom.

Column	What it holds
Date	The trade date
Action	Buy, Sell, Dividend, and so on
Security	What was bought, sold, or paid
Shares, Price, Comm.	The shares, the price per share, and the commission
Amount	The money involved
Cash	The account's cash after this transaction
Clr	c or R, as in any register
Memo	A note

A cash balance below zero shows ⚠ **below zero**: usually a missing deposit or a sale entered after the buy it paid for.

Enter a Transaction

Click the line **New transaction: type or click here**, or start typing on it. The entry dialog opens. Choose the **Action** first; the fields change to suit it.

> **Screenshot**
> The investment entry dialog for a Sell: Trade date, Security, Shares, Price per share, Commission, Net proceeds, and the lot picker listing the open lots with Shares to take.

Action	What it records
Buy	Shares bought with the account's cash; enter **Total cost**
Sell	Shares sold; enter **Net proceeds**

Action	What it records
Dividend, Interest	Cash paid by a security
Reinvest dividend	A dividend used to buy more shares
Reinvest ST / LT capital gain	A capital gain distribution used to buy more shares
ST / LT capital gain distribution	A fund's capital gain paid as cash
Return of capital	Cash paid back, which lowers the cost basis
Stock split	**Old shares** become **New shares**; cost stays the same
Transfer shares	Shares moved to another of your investment accounts, lots and all
Shares added	Shares that arrived without cash: enter **Cost basis** and **Originally acquired**
Shares removed	Shares that left without cash, such as a gift to charity
Roth conversion	Shares or cash moved from a traditional IRA to a Roth
Cash in, Cash out	Money moved into or out of the account
Fee	A fee charged to the account
Tax withheld	Tax held back from a payment
Misc income, Misc expense	Anything else

The fields every action shares:

- **Trade date** and **Settlement date** (optional).
- **Shares**, **Price per share**, and **Commission**. Kansha works out shares × price, with the commission, and shows it under the amount; leave the amount empty to take it.
- **Memo**.

The buttons at the bottom:

- **Enter/Next** saves and opens a fresh dialog for the next one.
- **Enter/Done** saves and closes.
- **Reset** clears the dialog; **Cancel** closes it without saving.
- When changing an existing transaction: **Delete** and **History...**.

> **Note**
> A dividend, interest, or capital gain distribution needs no category: Kansha files it under its built-in investment income categories, where the Investment Income and Tax Schedule reports find it.

Gifts of shares

To give shares to a charity, choose **Shares removed**, and under **Given to (optional; needs the price)** name the charity and enter the price on the day. Kansha records the gift at shares × price, with no gain, and the Tax Schedule flags non-cash gifts over $500 as **(Form 8283 needed)**.

Roth conversions

Choose **Roth conversion** in the traditional IRA. Enter the **Value converted**, the **To Roth IRA** account, any **Federal tax withheld** and **State tax withheld**, and the **Nontaxable part** if some of the money was already taxed (from Form 8606 or the plan's 1099-R). With no security chosen, the conversion is in cash. Tax withheld is paid from the IRA's cash on top of the value converted; leave it empty if you pay the tax from elsewhere.

Lots and Lot Methods

A **lot** is one purchase of a security: its date, its shares, and what they cost. When you sell, the shares come out of one or more lots, and the gain is the sale price minus what those lots cost. Shares held more than a year are long-term; the rest short-term.

Lot method decides which lots a sale takes:

Method	Takes
First in, first out	The oldest lots first
Choose lots	The lots you pick in the dialog
Average cost	Shares at the average cost of all lots (mutual funds)
Highest cost first	The most expensive lots, for the smallest gain
Minimum tax	Losses first (short-term, then long-term), then long-term gains, then short-term gains

Each account has a **Default lot method** (see Accounts), and each security in it can have its own. **Settings > Investments** sets the method for new accounts.

For **Choose lots**, the sell dialog lists each open lot with its **Acquired** date, **Open shares**, and **Term**. Type the number to sell from each under **Shares to take**.

> **Why this matters**
> The IRS lets you choose which shares you sold, as long as you tell your broker at the time. If your broker sold specific lots, choose the same ones here, so Kansha's gains match the 1099-B.

Matching your broker

Kansha's lots can drift from your broker's: an old import with no lots, a sale where the broker chose different shares, or a cost basis the broker adjusted. To fix a holding:

1. Download the cost-basis list (unrealized gains, by lot) from the broker as CSV.
2. In **Tools > Securities**, pick the security and click **True up lots...**.
3. Choose the **True-up date**, and the file, or paste its text into **Or paste the CSV**.
4. Click **Compare**. Kansha lists its lots beside the broker's.

5. Click **True up**. Kansha adjusts its lots to match, with the **Memo** you give.

For a traditional IRA, Roth, HSA, or 401(k), where the cost doesn't matter for taxes, only the shares are compared.

Seed lots... starts holdings from a CSV with one row per lot: account, security, acquired, quantity, cost basis. Each lot becomes a **Shares added** transaction on the seeding date and keeps its acquired date. Use it for shares from before your records start. **Preview** checks the file first.

Prices

Kansha values each holding at the latest price it has.

- **Download prices**, on the Investments screen, fetches today's prices for every security that has a ticker and isn't hidden. It needs **Allow price download (internet)** ticked in **Settings > Investments**; until then Kansha never goes online.
- **Tools > Import Prices...** reads a file of prices: one line per security, `ticker, price`, with an optional date as `MM/DD/YYYY`. Drop the file on the dialog or click **Choose file...**.
- In **Tools > Securities**, the **Prices** table takes a price by hand: date, price, **Add**.

A price older than 7 days counts as stale, and **Needs attention** on Insights says so. **Settings > Investments** changes the number of days.

The Investments Screen

Click **Investments** on the navigation bar.

> **Screenshot**
> The Investments screen: the bar with View, As of, Download prices, and the gear, and the table of holdings with Quote/Price, Shares, Cost Basis, Market Value, Gain/Loss, and Day Gain/Loss.

The table lists each holding with its **Quote/Price**, **Shares**, **Cost Basis**, **Market Value**, **Gain/Loss** in money and percent, and **Day Gain/Loss**.

- **As of** shows the holdings on another date.
- **View** switches among five views: **Default** and **Custom 2** through **Custom 5**.
- The gear's **Customize...** sets what a view shows: its **Columns**, **Accounts**, and **Securities**. **Reset view** puts it back.
- **Show closed lots**, in the gear, includes lots already sold.

Click a security to open its details: a graph of its market value or price history over a range you choose, with **Fit graph to data** to zoom in on the line.

> **Kansha Tip**
> Set up **Custom 2** with only your retirement accounts and **Custom 3** with only the taxable ones. Switching views is then one click.

Chapter 11

Reports

> **At a glance**
> Pick a report from the **Reports** menu. It opens with sensible settings; change the date range and the choices on its bar, or **Customize...** it further. Click any amount to see the transactions behind it. Save a report you'll run again, and export it to CSV or PDF.

The Reports Menu

Menu	Reports
Investing	Capital Gains, Investment Performance, Investment Income, Holdings, Asset Allocation
Net Worth	Net Worth
Spending	Itemized Categories, Itemized Payees, Income/Expense by Category, Income/Expense by Payee
Comparison	Current Spending vs. Average by Category, by Payee
Tax	Capital Gains, Tax Schedule, Tax Summary
Saved Reports	The reports you've saved, in their folders

Reports in Detail describes each one.

The Report Window

> **Screenshot**
> Income/Expense by Category for last year: the bar with Date range and Interval, the buttons Customize..., Save..., Expand all, Collapse all, Export CSV, and Save PDF..., and the report with INCOME and EXPENSES sections and a total.

The bar across the top holds the choices you change most:

- **Date range**: a preset such as **Year to date**, **Last month**, **Last 12 months**, or **Custom dates...**. Some presets add a second list to pick which month, quarter, or year.

- **Interval** (the two Income/Expense reports): one column per week, month, quarter, year, and so on, or **None** for one column. Net Worth has its Interval under **Customize… > Display**.
- **Subtotal by** (Capital Gains, Tax Summary, the comparisons): how the rows are grouped. The itemized reports have theirs under **Customize… > Display**: by category (or payee), or by tag first.
- **Sort by** (the itemized and tax reports): the order of the rows.
- **Compare to** (the comparisons): the past periods to average.

The buttons:

Button	What it does
Customize…	Opens the full settings; see below
Save… / Save / Save as…	Keeps the report with its settings; see Saved Reports
Expand all, Collapse all	Opens or folds every group
Export CSV	Saves the report as a CSV file in Downloads, for a spreadsheet
Save PDF…	Saves it as a PDF, portrait or landscape, and opens it in your PDF viewer to print

Reports with a graph have **Hide graph** and **Hide report** above each part.

See the transactions behind a number

Click any amount. Kansha opens the transactions that make it up, each of which opens in its register. A group's heading folds its rows away and brings them back.

> **Kansha Tip**
> Before you trust a category's total, click it. A transaction in the wrong category is easy to spot in the list, and fixing it fixes the report.

Customize

Customize… opens the full settings, in tabs.

Display:

- **Title** of the report.
- **Totals only**: the totals without the rows under them.
- **Totals on group heading**: a group's total on its heading line, as the tax forms show it.
- **Cents (no rounding)**: show cents, or round to whole dollars.
- **Accounts with zero balances** (Net Worth).
- **Transfers** and **Cash flow (transfers to other accounts)** (Income/Expense): whether money moved between accounts shows. With Cash flow, money moved to or from accounts not chosen on the Accounts tab is listed in a TRANSFERS section.
- **Show columns**: which columns appear; **Reset columns** puts them back.

Accounts, Categories, Payees, Securities, Tags: which ones the report includes. **Select all** and **Clear all** do what they say; **Contains** narrows the list as you type; **Show hidden and closed** lists those too.

> **Kansha Tip**
> To see one account's spending, open Income/Expense by Category, go to **Customize... > Accounts**, click **Clear all**, and tick that one account.

Saved Reports

Save... keeps a report with all its settings, date range included, under a name you give it, in a folder. **Save as...** keeps a copy under a new name. The saved report appears under **Reports > Saved Reports**, in its folder.

Reports > Saved Reports > Manage Saved Reports... opens, renames, moves, and deletes saved reports, and makes folders. **Unfiled** holds those not in a folder; it can't be deleted.

> **Kansha Tip**
> Save a report with a relative date range, such as **Last year** or **Last month**, and it shows the right dates every time you open it.

Tax Reports

The three Tax reports gather what your return needs:

- **Tax Schedule** lists each tax line, such as Schedule A charitable gifts or Schedule B interest, with the transactions under it. It follows the tax lines set on your categories and accounts (see Categories, Payees, and Tags). Non-cash gifts to charity over $500 are marked **(Form 8283 needed)**.
- **Tax Summary** lists every tax-related transaction, subtotaled by category, tax line, account, payee, tag, or period.
- **Capital Gains** lists every sale with its proceeds, cost basis, and gain, short-term and long-term apart. It leaves out the tax-deferred and tax-exempt accounts.

All three start at **Last year**.

> **Why this matters**
> Kansha's numbers come from what you entered. Your broker's 1099-B and the bank's 1099-INT are the numbers the IRS has. Compare them before you file; if they differ, find out why, and fix Kansha or ask the broker.

Printing

Save PDF... asks for portrait or landscape, saves the PDF, and opens it in your PDF viewer. Print from there.

Chapter 12

Insights

> **At a glance**
> **Insights** is the home page: tabs of cards, each card a small report that keeps itself up to date. A new book starts with one tab, **Status**. Add tabs, choose their cards, and make spending cards of your own.

Open Insights

Click **Insights** on the navigation bar, or choose **Tools > Insights**. It's also what Kansha opens to at startup, unless Settings says otherwise (see Settings and Themes).

> **Screenshot**
> The Status insight: the Net worth card with three year-end columns, This month, Net worth over time, Due soon, and Needs attention with its check mark.

The Cards

Card	What it shows
Net worth	Each account group, and net worth, today and at the last two year-ends
This month	This month's income and spending so far
Net worth over time	A graph over 1, 2, or 5 years; **Fit graph to data** zooms in on the line
Due soon	Scheduled transactions due in the next 14 days
Needs attention	Problems in the book, each with where to fix it
Spending cards	Spending in the categories you choose; see below

Due soon looks ahead 14 days unless Settings says otherwise.

Needs attention

Kansha runs a set of checks each time Insights opens:

- the last integrity check, the last backup, and whether it was verified;

- whether the backup folder is there;
- prices that are stale or missing;
- overdue scheduled transactions;
- transactions not cleared after 60 days;
- accounts not reconciled in 60 days;
- uncategorized transactions;
- investment cash below zero.

When all pass, the card shows ✓ **No problems found.** and how many checks passed. Otherwise it shows ⚠ and lists each problem. **Show checks** lists every check, passed or not.

> **Kansha Tip**
> Glance at Needs attention once a week. It catches the small things, such as a payment with no category, before they add up.

Spending Cards

A spending card totals the categories you choose: everything for the house, or food in all its subcategories. It shows the **Year**, the **Month**, and the **Monthly Avg**, one row per category.

To make one, open the insight's gear, choose **Customize...**, and click **New spending card...**. Give it a **Name**, then tick its **Categories**, and on the **Accounts** tab the accounts it counts.

A spending card has its own gear with **Customize...** and **Delete card...**. **Settings > Interface** sets how many rows a spending card shows before it scrolls (10 to start with).

Arrange Insights

The gear at the end of the tabs holds:

- **Customize...**: the insight's **Name**, and its cards. **Available cards** lists the cards not on it; **On this insight (in order)** lists those on it. **Add ›** and **‹ Remove** move a card between the two; **▲ Up** and **▼ Down** change the order.
- **Create new insight...**: a new tab.
- **Move left**, **Move right**: the tab's place.
- **Delete insight...**: removes the tab.

> **Kansha Tip**
> Make a second insight called **Taxes**, with spending cards for charity, medical, and the other deductions you track. In December it answers "how are we doing for the year?" at a glance.

Chapter 13

Entering from the Command Line

> **At a glance**
> `kansha add` enters a purchase from a terminal without opening the app. Entries also come as files, from a script or sent from a phone. None of them touches your accounts until you approve it in Kansha, under **File > Review Entries...**.

What Can Be Entered

Spending only: purchases, bills, and refunds, split or not, in an open checking, savings, cash, or credit card account, with an **expense** category. Transfers, income, and investment transactions are entered in the app.

> **Why this matters**
> An entry from outside is **unverified**. It waits in a list of its own and changes no balance, register, or report until you approve it. That way a mistyped command or a file from the wrong phone can't change your books behind your back.

kansha add

> **Note**
> The command line is for Kubuntu, where the installer puts `kansha` on the path. On Windows, use **File > Import Entries...** with a file instead.

Type `kansha add` in a terminal, and it asks for each field:

```
$ kansha add
Date [today]:
Payee: Shell
Amount: 45.20
Account: Double Cash
Category (or split): Auto:Fuel
Memo (Enter for none): Ohio trip
accepted (unverified): 1 entry for household
```

- **Date**: press Enter for today, or type `yesterday`, a date like `2026-10-12`, or one in the book's date format.

- **Amount** can be a sum, as in the register: `3.99*2+1.50`. Type `=` to work it out before moving on. A refund is negative.
- **Account** and **Category**: press **Tab** to complete the name. The end of a name is enough when only one name ends that way: `Groceries` finds `Food:Groceries`. A wrong name is asked again, with the close matches.
- **Category (or split)**: type `split` to split the amount. Kansha then asks for each line, `Line 1 amount (182.40 left):`, and its category, until nothing is left. A line can be typed as the amount and category together: `120.00 Groceries`.

In one line

For a script, or once you know the format, give the whole entry on the command line:

```
kansha add today Shell 45.20 Auto:Fuel acct "Double Cash"
```

The entry format is in The Entry File Format. A name with spaces goes in quotes.

Options

Option	What it does
`--book <path>`	The book's `.db` file. Without it, `KANSHA_DB`, else the last book opened
`--from <name>`	Who sent it, shown at review. Without it, `command line`
`kansha run <file>`	Reads a file of entries
`kansha run -`	Reads entries from standard input
`kansha help`	Shows the usage

Where entries go

`kansha add` doesn't open the book and needs no passphrase. It writes the entries to the book's inbox, a folder beside the book named `<book>-inbox`, and answers `accepted (unverified)`. That's all it ever answers: no balances, nothing from the book.

It checks names against the **names copy**, `<book>-names.txt` beside the book. Kansha writes it each time the book closes. If there's no copy yet, the command says names weren't checked, and the review in Kansha checks them instead.

Entry Files

A file of entries starts with the line `kansha-entries 1`:

```
kansha-entries 1
from "Stan's phone"
2026-10-12 Shell 45.20 Auto:Fuel acct "Double Cash"
2026-10-12 Costco 182.40 split acct Checking
  120.00 Food:Groceries
  62.40 Household memo "paper goods"
```

Bring one in with **File > Import Entries...**, or drop it in the book's inbox folder. Kansha watches the inbox while the book is open, and reads it when the book opens.

A file goes in whole or not at all: if any line is wrong, Kansha lists each bad line by its number and takes none of them.

From a phone

File > Export Names for Phones... writes a `kansha-names 1` file: your expense categories and open spending accounts, no payees and no amounts. A phone app can use it to offer the right names, then send back an entries file by email or a chat app. Save the file and use **File > Import Entries...**.

> **Note**
> Entry files and the names file are plain text, not encrypted, until Kansha reads them. They hold only what you entered and the names of categories and accounts.

Review Entries

When the book opens with entries waiting, Kansha shows **Review entries**. Otherwise, **File > Review Entries... (n)** shows how many are waiting.

> **Screenshot**
> The Review entries dialog with three entries: From, Date, Payee, Amount, Account, Category, and Memo, each with Approve, Edit, and Reject, and one row marked ⚠ for a category name that doesn't match.

For each entry:

- **Approve** makes it an ordinary transaction in its register.
- **Approve and open** approves it and opens it in the register, to change a split.
- **Edit** changes it in the list first. A name marked ⚠ doesn't match the book; fix it here before approving.
- **Reject** throws it away.
- **Later** leaves the rest for another time.

Undo takes back an approval: the transaction goes and the entry is back in the list.

Each entry has an ID, so a file sent twice adds nothing the second time.

Chapter 14

Backups and Restore

At a glance
Kansha backs up the book by itself: when it closes, a few minutes after a change, and before anything big. Each backup is one encrypted file in the backup folder, opened with the book's passphrase. **File > Restore...** brings a book back from one, and shows what you'd gain or lose first.

How Backups Work

A backup is a single `.zip` file holding the whole book, encrypted with the backup passphrase. Its name says which book, when, and why:

```
household-20261012-183005Z-close.zip
```

The time is in UTC (the `Z`). The last word is the kind:

Kind	Made
manual	When you choose **File > Back Up Now**
close	When the book closes
timeout	A few minutes after a change, while you work
bulk	Before a change to many transactions, such as a merge or Replace all
import	Before an import
migration	Before a new version of Kansha updates the book
restore	Before a restore replaces the book

Why this matters
A backup made just before a big change means the change can always be taken back, however it goes. That's why Kansha doesn't ask: the backup costs a second and could save the book.

Settings > Backups

Choose **Edit > Settings...** and **Backups**.

> **Screenshot**
> Settings, Backups page: the Backup folder with Browse... and Use Downloads, the three numbers for keeping backups, and the Backup tools list with Apply.

- **Backup folder**: where every backup goes. **Browse...** picks another; **Use Downloads** goes back to Downloads. If the folder goes missing, such as a USB drive that isn't plugged in, Kansha says ⚠ **This folder is missing...**.
- **Keep the newest automatic backups**: 10 to start with.
- **... plus one per month for (months)**: 12 to start with, so a year of month-end backups stays too.
- **Back up after a change (minutes, 0 = off)**: 5 to start with.

Kansha removes older automatic backups beyond those. **Manual backups are never removed**; delete them yourself when you no longer want them.

> **Kansha Tip**
> Make the backup folder one that's copied off the computer: a cloud folder such as Dropbox or OneDrive, or a network drive. The backups are encrypted, so a cloud service can store them but can't read them.

Backup tools

Pick one from **Backup tools** and click **Apply**:

- **Change backup passphrase...**: a new passphrase for the book and for backups made from now on. Older backups keep the passphrase they were made with; keep a note of it as long as you keep them.
- **Show database key...**: after the passphrase, shows the key that unlocks the book file itself. With it, a database tool such as DB Browser for SQLite (SQLCipher build) can open the book to look, not to change.
- **Verify backup...**: opens a backup, checks it, and says ✓ **The backup opens and passes the integrity check.**

> **Kansha Tip**
> Once a month, run **Verify backup...** on the newest backup. A backup you've never opened is only a hope.

Restore

Choose **File > Restore...**, or **Restore from a backup...** on the passphrase screen, and click **Choose backup file...**.

Screenshot
The Restore from backup window: the backup's Book, Made, Kind, Kansha version, and Schema version, and the table comparing transactions and balances in the backup with the current book.

Kansha opens the backup and shows:

- the **Book** it came from, when it was **Made**, its **Kind**, and the **Kansha version** and **Schema version** that made it;
- each account's **Transactions** and **Balance**, in the backup and in the current book;
- what's **Only in the backup**, and what's **Only in the current book (lost by restoring)**.

Show only rows that differ hides the accounts that match.

Restoring replaces the whole book with the backup. Kansha backs up the current book first, as a **restore** backup, so even a restore can be undone.

To restore another book's backup into this one, tick **Replace this book with the other book's data**. Kansha asks so it doesn't happen by mistake.

> **Note**
> A backup from a newer version of Kansha can't be opened by an older one. Install the newer Kansha first.

Move to Another Computer

1. On the old computer, choose **File > Back Up Now**.
2. Copy that backup to the new computer, or use the shared backup folder.
3. Install Kansha on the new computer. On the **Set up** screen, choose **Restore from a backup**, pick the file, and type its passphrase.

Or copy the book's two files, `.db` and `.key`, and open them with **Open another book...** (see Getting Started).

Integrity Check

File > Integrity Check checks the whole book: every transaction balances, each holding's shares equal its open lots, lots keep their cost basis, and nothing points at something that isn't there. It only looks; it changes nothing. It ends with **No problems found.** or a list of what's wrong. **Settings > Data** can run it each time the book opens.

History

Every change to the book is recorded. **History...**, in a register's right-click menu, the investment entry dialog, or the account dialog, lists a transaction's or account's changes: the **Field**, the value **Before**, and the value **After**.

New Books and Year-End

File > New… makes another book. Besides **Empty** and **Standard categories**, it can start as a **Copy of this book**, with a choice of balances:

- **Zero**: the accounts and categories, no transactions.
- **Carry each balance**: each account starts with its balance on the **carry date**.
- **Carry, and keep transactions after the carry date**.

File > Rename Book… renames the book and its files; it asks for the passphrase.

> **Kansha Tip**
> There's no need to start a new book each year. A Kansha book holds decades without slowing down, and reports pick any dates you like.

Chapter 15

Settings and Themes

At a glance
Edit > Settings... holds the book's settings, in six groups. They're kept in the book, so they move with it. The theme, font, and text size are on the menu bar and belong to this computer. **Edit > Navigation Bar...** chooses the buttons along the top.

Settings

Choose **Edit > Settings...**. Pick a group on the left; its settings show on the right.

Screenshot
The Settings dialog on the Interface group: Date format, First day of week, On startup open to, Account list side, Show cents in account bar balances, and Rows shown on spending cards.

Interface

Setting	What it does
Date format	How dates are shown and typed
First day of week	Sunday or Monday, for the Calendar and weekly reports
On startup open to	The screen Kansha shows when the book opens
Account list side	The Accounts panel on the left or the right
Show cents in account bar balances	Cents in the Accounts panel, or whole dollars
Rows shown on spending cards (more rows scroll)	See Insights

Data

Setting	What it does
Integrity check at startup	Checks the book each time it opens
Due soon shows items due within (days)	The Due soon card's reach

Investments

Setting	What it does
Price is stale after (days)	When Needs attention flags an old price
Lot method for new investment accounts	Their default lot method
Allow price download (internet)	Lets **Download prices** go online

Register

Setting	What it does
Gray reconciled transactions	Shows reconciled rows in gray
Recall memorized payees	Fills in from a payee's last use
Automatically memorize new payees	Remembers new payees as you enter them
Capitalize payees and categories	Capitalizes words as you type
Remove memorized payees not used in last (months, 0 = never)	Clears out old payees

Notifications

Each asks before saving a transaction that may be a mistake:

Setting	Asks when
When entering out-of-date transactions	The date is over 7 days past or 30 days ahead
A check number is reused	The number is already used in the account
When entering uncategorized transactions	A line, split lines included, has no category
Ask before saving changes to an existing transaction	You change a transaction already saved

Backups

See Backups and Restore.

Themes and Fonts

Three lists at the right end of the menu bar:

- **Theme**: Nordic, Light, Dark, Classic, or Matrix.
- **Font**: System, Arial, Verdana, or Courier New.
- **Font size**: 10 to 24; everything grows with it.

They take effect at once, and are kept for this computer rather than in the book.

> **Kansha Tip**
> Negative amounts always carry a minus sign as well as a color, so they read the same in every theme, whatever colors you can tell apart.

The Navigation Bar

The bar under the menus starts with **Back** and **Forward**, which step through the screens you've visited, then buttons for the screens you use most: Insights, Reminders, Calendar, Reconcile, and Investments to start with. The search box is at its end.

Choose **Edit > Navigation Bar...** to change the buttons:

- **Available** lists everything that can go on the bar: any menu item, Investments, and any account.
- **On the bar (left to right)** lists what's there now.
- **Add ›** and **‹ Remove** move an item between the two; **▲ Up** and **▼ Down** change the order.
- **Reset to default** puts back the starting set.

Click **Save**.

> **Kansha Tip**
> Put your checking account and the reports you run most on the bar. They're then one click away from anywhere.

Chapter 16

Recipes

> **At a glance**
> Short step-by-step answers to everyday jobs. Each points to the chapter with the details.

Pay the Credit Card

The payment is a transfer from checking to the card.

1. Open the checking register.
2. Enter the date, the payee (the card company), and the amount under **Payment**.
3. In **Category**, choose the credit card account.

The payment shows in both registers. To pay it every month, right-click it and choose **Schedule this...** (see Scheduled Transactions).

Enter a Paycheck

1. Open the checking register. Enter the date, the employer as payee, and the net pay that reached the bank under **Deposit**.
2. Click **Split**.
3. Add a line for the gross salary in **Salary**, as a positive amount.
4. Add a line for each deduction, with a leading `-`: `-412.50` in **Tax:Fed**, `-118.20` in **Tax:State**, `-250.00` to the 401(k) account as a transfer, and so on.
5. When **Remainder** shows ✓, click **Enter**.

Then right-click it and choose **Schedule this...**, with **Twice a month** or **Weekly** every 2 weeks. Each payday, enter it from Due and overdue and change any amounts that changed.

Take Cash from an ATM

A transfer from checking to your Cash account: in checking, enter the amount under **Payment**, with **Cash** as the category. Spend from the Cash account as you like. If you don't track cash that closely, use an expense category of your own for it instead of a transfer.

Record a Refund

In the account the refund went to, enter it with the same payee and category as the purchase, with the amount in the other column: **Deposit** for a bank, **Payment** for a credit card. The category's total goes down, as it should.

Move Money to Savings

In checking, enter the amount under **Payment**, with the savings account as the category. To save every month, schedule it.

Split a Store Receipt

A purchase that was part groceries and part household goods:

1. Enter the total as usual, then click **Split**.
2. One line: the grocery part in **Food:Groceries**.
3. Second line: the rest in **Household**. **Remainder** reaches ✓.

Fix a Category on Many Transactions

1. **Edit > Find/Replace...**.
2. Find: **Category**, **Exactly**, the wrong category. Add a row for the **Payee** if only some of them are wrong.
3. **Select all**, or tick the ones to change.
4. Replace **Category** with the right one and click **Replace all**.

One **Undo** reverses it (see The Register).

Clean Up Duplicate Payees

Tools > Memorized Payees, click the misspelled one, and **Merge** it into the right one. Every transaction moves across.

Give Shares to Charity

In the investment account, enter **Shares removed**, choose the security and shares, enter the day's price, and name the charity under **Given to**. The Tax Schedule lists the gift at its value (see Investments).

Record a Required Distribution from an IRA

In the IRA register, **Sell** what the plan sold, if anything, then **Cash out** the distribution to checking. Enter any tax held back with **Tax withheld**.

Track a Trip or Project

Make a tag, such as `Maine 2026`, in **Tools > Tags**. Tag each transaction for it as you enter it, split lines included. Then run **Reports > Spending > Itemized Categories** and choose just that tag under **Customize... > Tags** (see Reports).

See What You Spent Last Year

Reports > Spending > Income/Expense by Category, **Date range Last year**. Set **Interval** to **Month** to see each month side by side. Click any amount for the transactions.

Get Ready for Taxes

In January or February, after the year's statements are reconciled:

1. **Reports > Tax > Tax Schedule**, **Last year**: each tax line with its transactions. **Save PDF...** for your records or your preparer.
2. **Reports > Tax > Capital Gains**, **Last year**: compare it with each broker's 1099-B.
3. **Reports > Investing > Investment Income**, **Last year**: compare it with the 1099-DIV and 1099-INT forms.
4. Look at **Uncategorized** in Needs attention; a missing category may be a missing deduction.

Use Kansha on Two Computers

Kansha is for one person at a time. To use it on two computers, keep the book in one place and carry it: on a USB drive, or by restoring the newest backup on the other computer each time. Never open the same book on two computers at once, or from a folder that syncs both ways while it's open.

> **Why this matters**
> A synced folder copies the book file while Kansha is writing it. Two copies changed at once can't be merged, and one set of changes is lost.

Chapter 17

Something Doesn’t Look Right

> **At a glance**
> The common surprises, and what to do about them. Start with **Needs attention** on Insights; it finds many of these by itself.

Balances

The balance doesn’t match the bank. Compare the register’s **Cleared** balance with the bank’s, not **Current**: the bank hasn’t seen what’s still on its way. Then reconcile against the last statement (see Reconciling).

The balance is different from yesterday’s, and I didn’t change anything. Look for a transaction dated today that was entered ahead, or a schedule set to **Enter automatically**. **Current** moves to include future-dated rows as their day comes.

A reconciled account’s opening balance changed. A reconciled transaction was changed or deleted. The Reconcile view lists it under ⚠ **Opening balance changed.**; put it back as it was.

Net worth looks too low (or too high). An investment’s price may be old or missing: see **Needs attention**. Or a card or loan’s starting balance went in the wrong column, so it counts as money you have instead of money you owe; check its Opening Balance transaction.

Entering

Kansha asks “Create new expense category…?” when I type a category. The name isn’t in the list. Say no and pick the right one, or yes to make it.

The payee didn’t fill in the category. QuickFill fills only an empty field, only on a new transaction, and only for a payee it has memorized. Check **Recall memorized payees** in **Settings > Register**, and that the payee isn’t hidden.

The transaction won’t save: a split. The split lines must add up to the amount. **Remainder** shows what’s left; add a line or fix an amount until it shows ✓.

Kansha asks before I save. One of the notifications caught it: a date far from today, a check number used before, or a missing category. Check, then save, or turn the warning off in **Settings > Notifications**.

I can't change a transaction. If its account is closed, reopen the account first. If it's reconciled, Kansha asks before changing it. An investment transaction is changed in the investment register, not from the other side of a transfer.

I deleted the wrong thing. Edit > Undo (**Ctrl+Z**) takes back the last register change. For anything bigger, restore a backup from before it (see Backups and Restore).

Investments

Shares or cost basis don't match the broker. Lots drift for many reasons. Use **True up lots...** with the broker's cost-basis CSV (see Investments).

Cash shows ⚠ below zero. A buy is entered before the money that paid for it, or a deposit is missing. Look at the rows just above the first negative cash.

Download prices does nothing. Tick **Allow price download (internet)** in **Settings > Investments**. A security needs a ticker and must not be hidden.

A sale's gain is different from the 1099-B. The broker sold different lots. Edit the sale, choose **Choose lots**, and pick the broker's lots.

Reports

A report total looks wrong. Click it to see the transactions behind it. Look for one in the wrong category, the wrong date, or a transfer counted as spending.

A category is missing from a report. Check **Customize... > Categories**: it may be cleared. Hidden categories show only with **Show hidden and closed** ticked.

Capital gains for an IRA don't show. They aren't taxed, so the Capital Gains report leaves out tax-deferred and tax-exempt accounts unless you choose them in **Customize... > Accounts**.

Schedules

A bill didn't show as due. Check its **Remind days before due** and its next date in **Reminders**. A schedule whose **End** has passed, or with no occurrences left, is finished.

I can't enter next month's bill. Only the earliest occurrence of a schedule can be entered or skipped. Enter or skip this month's first.

Backups and Opening

The passphrase isn't accepted. Passphrases are exact: check Caps Lock and the spaces. If you changed the passphrase, an older backup still needs the old one.

⚠ **This folder is missing.** The backup folder isn't there: a USB drive unplugged, or a network drive not connected. Connect it, or choose another in **Settings > Backups**.

Kansha says the book was made by a newer version. Install the newest Kansha. A book that a newer version has updated can't go back to an older one.

The window opens too small, or off the screen. Kansha remembers the window’s size and place for this computer. Close Kansha and delete `config.json` in the settings folder (see Getting Started) to start fresh. The theme, font, and list of recent books start fresh too; the books aren’t touched.

Still Stuck

File > Integrity Check checks the whole book and lists anything wrong. If it finds something you can’t fix, restore the last backup from before the problem started.

Appendix A

Reports in Detail

Each report, what it shows, and the choices it has beyond the date range. Every report has **Totals only** in Customize, except Asset Allocation. See Reports for the window they share.

Investing

Capital Gains. Every sale in the date range, lot by lot: shares, date bought, date sold, proceeds, cost basis, and gain or loss, short-term and long-term apart. For checking against the broker's 1099-B. **Subtotal by**: Short vs. long-term, Month, Quarter, Year, Account, Security, or Don't subtotal. Filters: Accounts, Securities. With no accounts chosen, it covers the taxable accounts only.

Investment Performance. How each account's investments did over the date range: the internal rate of return and the time-weighted return, which leaves out the effect of money moved in and out. Filter: Accounts.

Investment Income. Dividends, interest, short- and long-term capital gain distributions, and other income, by security and account, whether paid in cash or reinvested. Filters: Accounts, Securities.

Holdings. Each holding on a date: shares, cost basis, market value, and unrealized gain. An account's own cash is a row of its own. A holding with no price has no market value. Filters: Accounts, Securities.

Asset Allocation. Market value by asset class on a date, as a table and a chart. Investment cash counts as Cash. Click a class to open Holdings for its securities. Filter: Accounts.

Net Worth

Net Worth. Assets, liabilities, and net worth by account group, on a date or over time, with a graph. **Interval** (in Customize): None for one date, or a column per week, month, quarter, year, and so on. **Accounts with zero balances** shows the empty ones. Filter: Accounts; with a few accounts and Interval None, it's a list of their balances.

Spending

Itemized Categories. Every transaction in the range, grouped under INCOME, EXPENSES, and TRANSFERS by category and subcategory, with totals on each heading. **Sort by**: Date/Account, Account/Date, or Amount; the Date, Account, and Num headings sort too. **Subtotal by** (Customize):

Category, or Tag, then category. Transfers are off until you turn them on in Customize. Filters: Accounts, Categories, Payees, Tags.

Itemized Payees. The same, grouped by payee.

Income/Expense by Category. Totals for each category, with subcategories folded into their parents, for the range. **Interval** spreads them into a column per week, month, quarter, or year, to see trends. **Cash flow (transfers to other accounts)** adds a TRANSFERS section listing money moved to or from accounts not chosen, such as a loan payment or a deposit to a brokerage, so the total is what the chosen accounts gained or lost. Filters: Accounts, Categories, Payees, Tags.

Income/Expense by Payee. The same, totaled by payee.

Comparison

Current Spending vs. Average by Category. Spending in the range beside the average of the periods before it. **Date range** offers weeks, months, quarters, and years: Current week, Last week, Current month, and so on. **Compare to** offers periods to match:

Date range	Compare to
A week	Last 4, 8, or 12 weeks
A month	Last 3, 6, or 12 months
A quarter	Last 4, 8, or 12 quarters
A year	Last year, Last 3 or 5 years

The compared periods end on the range's last day, so they include it. Periods with nothing count, at zero. Filters: Accounts, Categories, Payees.

Current Spending vs. Average by Payee. The same, by payee.

Tax

Capital Gains. The Investing report above, starting at Last year.

Tax Schedule. Amounts by tax form and line, such as Schedule A, B, and D, with the transactions under each, from the taxable accounts. Schedule D comes from the lots sold, by holding period. The form rows are shaded and the totals sit on the heading lines. **Date range** also offers **Monthly**, **Quarterly**, and **Yearly**, for estimated taxes. Non-cash gifts to charity over $500 are marked **(Form 8283 needed)**. Filters: Accounts, Categories, Payees, Securities.

Tax Summary. Every tax-related transaction: tax-related categories, investment income, taxable gains, and withholding. **Subtotal by**: Category (the default, with INCOME, EXPENSES, and TRANSFERS), Tax line, Account, Payee, Tag, Month, Quarter, Year, or Don't subtotal. **Sort by** as the itemized reports. Starts at Last year, sorted Account/Date. Filters: Accounts, Categories, Payees, Tags.

> **Note**
> Kansha gathers the numbers for a return; it doesn't work out the tax.

Date Ranges

Choice	Covers
Include all dates	Everything in the book
Month to date, Quarter to date, Year to date	From the start of the period to today
Last month, Last quarter, Last year	The whole period before this one
Last 30 days, Last 12 months	Back from today
Custom dates…	Any from and to dates
Monthly, Quarterly, Yearly	Tax Schedule: a second list picks which one

The comparison reports have their own list: Current and Last week, month, quarter, and year. The first day of a week follows **Settings > Interface**.

Appendix B

The Entry File Format

The `kansha-entries 1` format, used by `kansha add`, `kansha run`, **File > Import Entries...**, and files sent from a phone (see Entering from the Command Line).

A File

```
kansha-entries 1
from "Stan's phone"
# Ohio trip
2026-10-12 Shell 45.20 Auto:Fuel acct "Double Cash" memo "Ohio trip"
2026-10-12 Costco 182.40 split acct Checking
  120.00 Food:Groceries
  62.40 Household memo "paper goods"
2026-10-14 Costco -24.99 Household acct Checking memo "return"
```

- The first line is `kansha-entries 1`: the format and its version.
- `from "<sender>"`, optional, names who sent the file. Review shows it.
- Then one entry per line. Blank lines are skipped.

An Entry

```
<date> <payee> <amount> <category or split> acct <account>
    [memo "<text>"] [id <uuid>]
```

Part	Rules
date	`2026-10-12`. `kansha add` and `kansha run` also take `today`, `yesterday`, and the book's date format
payee	Any text. A new payee is made when the entry is approved
amount	`45.20`. Negative for a refund: `-24.99`
category	An existing expense category, or `split`
`acct`	Required: an open checking, savings, cash, or credit card account
`memo`	Optional

Part	Rules
`id`	Optional unique ID; Kansha makes one if it's missing. An entry whose ID was seen before is skipped

`acct`, `memo`, and `id` can come in any order after the category.

Splits

With `split` as the category, the split lines follow, indented:

```
<amount> <category> [memo "<text>"]
```

Every line has its amount, and the lines add up to the entry's amount.

Words and Names

- Words are separated by spaces. A name with spaces goes in double quotes: `"Double Cash"`. Inside quotes, `\"` is a quote and `\\` a backslash.
- A name spelled like one of the format's own words (`acct`, `memo`, `id`, `split`) is quoted too.
- `#` outside quotes starts a comment, to the end of the line.
- Case doesn't matter in names. The end of a category's name is enough when only one category ends that way: `Groceries` for `Food:Groceries`.
- A name that matches nothing, or more than one, is an error that lists the close matches. Kansha never guesses and never creates a category from an entry.

Rules for a File

- A file goes in whole or not at all. Every bad line is listed by its number.
- The largest file read is 1 MB.

kansha add Answers

Answer	Means
`accepted (unverified): 2 entries for household`	Written to the inbox, waiting for review
`names not checked: there is no names copy yet …`	Close the book in Kansha once to make the copy; until then review checks the names
An error listing close matches	Nothing was saved; fix the name and try again

The Names File

File > Export Names for Phones… writes a `kansha-names 1` file: the expense categories, with their subcategories, and the open spending accounts. It holds no payees and no amounts. Kansha keeps

a copy beside the book, `<book>-names.txt`, written each time the book closes, for `kansha add` to check names against.

Appendix C

Keyboard Shortcuts

Anywhere

Key	What it does
Ctrl+Z	Undo the last register change
Ctrl+F	Go to the search box
Escape	Close a dialog or menu
Arrow keys, in an open menu	Move through the menus

In a Register

With a row selected:

Key	What it does
↑ ↓	Previous or next row
Home, End	First or last row
Page Up, Page Down	A page up or down
Enter	Change the row
Space	Mark it cleared, or unmark it
Delete	Delete it
Insert, Ctrl+N	Go to the entry line
Shift+F10, Menu key	The right-click menu

While entering or changing:

Key	What it does
Tab, Shift+Tab	Next or previous field
Enter	Save; when changing, move on to the next row
Escape	Cancel

In a Date Field

Key	What it does
`+` or `=`	One day later
`-`	One day earlier
`t`	Today

A short date is completed: `3/5` is March 5 of this year.

In an Amount Field

Type	Gets
`12.50+3.25`	A sum, worked out when you move on
`3*4.99`	`*` and `/` before `+` and `-`
`=`	The sum worked out at once

In a Name Field

Key	What it does
↑ ↓	Move through the matches
Enter, Tab	Take the match
:	Go down a level in a category
Escape	Close the list

kansha add

Key	What it does
Tab	Complete an account or category name
=	Work out a sum
Enter on Date	Today
Enter on Memo	No memo

Appendix D

Glossary

Account. Anywhere money is kept or owed. See Accounts.

Asset. Something you own: money in the bank, investments, a house. It adds to net worth.

Asset class. The kind of investment a security is, such as U.S. stocks, international stocks, bonds, or cash, for the Asset Allocation report.

Backup. One encrypted file holding the whole book, made by itself or by **File > Back Up Now**. See Backups and Restore.

Backup passphrase. The passphrase that opens the book and its backups. Lost, it can't be recovered.

Book. Everything Kansha keeps for one household: two files, `<name>.db` and `<name>.key`. Quicken calls it a data file.

Built-in category. A category Kansha itself needs, such as Opening Balance or Uncategorized. Only its tax settings and Hidden can change.

Category. What money was for or from: Groceries, Salary. Income or Expense, and nested with `:`.

Cleared. Seen on the bank's side; `c` in the register.

Cost basis. What shares cost, commissions included. The gain on a sale is the proceeds minus the cost basis.

Entry line. The empty line at the bottom of a register where new transactions are typed.

Estimate. A scheduled amount worked out as the average of past payments.

Holding. The shares of one security in one account.

Inbox. The folder beside the book, `<book>-inbox`, where entries from the command line wait for Kansha to read them.

Insight. A tab of cards on the home page. See Insights.

Liability. Something you owe: a credit card, a loan. It takes away from net worth.

Lot. One purchase of a security: its date, shares, and cost.

Lot method. The rule that picks which lots a sale takes.

Memorized payee. A payee Kansha remembers, with the category, memo, and amount of its last use, to fill them in next time.

Navigation bar. The row of buttons under the menus.

Needs attention. The Insights card that lists problems in the book.

Net worth. Assets minus liabilities.

Opening Balance. The built-in category of each account's first transaction, its starting balance.

Payee. Who money went to or came from.

Reconcile. Check an account against its statement; the matched transactions become R. See Reconciling.

Register. An account's list of transactions.

Reminder. A schedule in **Remind me** mode, or the Reminders view that lists all schedules.

Schedule. A transaction that repeats. See Scheduled Transactions.

Security. A stock, fund, bond, or anything else with shares and a price.

Split. One transaction with several categories or transfers.

Stale price. A price older than the days set in Settings (7 to start with).

Tag. A label that marks transactions across categories; Quicken calls it a class.

Tax line. The line of a tax form a category or transfer belongs on.

Tax treatment. How the IRS sees an account: taxable, tax-deferred, or tax-exempt.

Transfer. Money moved between two of your accounts, entered once and shown in both.

True up. Make Kansha's lots match the broker's, from the broker's cost-basis file.

Unverified. An entry from the command line or a file, waiting for review. It changes nothing until approved.

Void. Keep a transaction but make its amount zero, as for a cancelled check.